

Windows 11 Optimization Guide for Older PCs

Before proceeding, create a system restore point.

1. System Services (services.msc)

Service Name	Why Disable?	Don't Disable If You Use This
Connected User Experiences and Telemetry	Sends usage/diagnostic data.	None (Improves privacy.)
Print Spooler	Manages printing jobs.	Any printer (physical or virtual)
Fax	Manages fax services.	A physical fax machine connected to your PC.
Geolocation Service & Downloaded Maps Manager	Location and map data services.	Windows Maps or other location-based services.
Windows Search	File indexing for fast search. Set to Manual if you use search occasionally.	Frequently search for files on PC
Xbox Services (All)	Gaming features and Game Bar.	Xbox app or Game Bar.

2. Visual Effects and Animations

1. Search for **"Adjust the appearance and performance of Windows"**.
2. In the Performance Options window, select **Adjust for best performance**.
3. *Recommended:* Keep **"Smooth edges of screen fonts"** checked for readability.

3. Startup Programs (Task Manager)

1. Open Task Manager (**Ctrl + Shift + Esc**)
2. Go to the **Startup apps** tab.
3. Disable any programs you don't need running immediately upon login (check Startup impact).

4. Background Apps and Features (Settings)

- **Background Apps:** Go to **Settings > Apps > Installed apps**. For non-essential apps, set *Let this app run in background* to **Never**.
- **Widgets:** Right-click **Taskbar > Taskbar settings**. Toggle **Widgets Off**, then uninstall "Microsoft News".

- **Windows Update Delivery Optimization:** Go to **Settings > Windows Update > Advanced options > Delivery Optimization**. Toggle **Allow downloads from other PCs** to **Off**.
- **Disable Transparency:** Go to **Settings > Personalization > Colors**. Toggle **Transparency effects** to **Off**.